

ARCANISTUDIO

Brand Guidelines

How the mark, the palette, the type and the voice hold together
— across the website, proposals, social, and everything we
ship for clients.

What's **inside**

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Every value in this document is the live value in `src/styles/global.css`. If a token changes there, it changes here — the code is the source of truth, this book is the explanation.

The foundation

Everything else in this book — the orange, the serif, the spacing — only makes sense if this part is agreed on first.

WHAT WE ARE

A web and app development agency serving founders and brands in Algeria and internationally. Design, code, testing and deployment handled end to end — one team, no handoffs.

WHO WE SERVE

Founders and product leads at funded and early-stage startups who are comparing agencies. They want to feel we're technically sharp and won't hand them something generic.

WHAT WE PROMISE

Measurable results, not deliverables: fast load times, clean semantic structure, technical SEO from the first commit. Full ownership of code, design and data on final payment.

TAGLINE

Digital Solutions With Purpose

FR — Des solutions digitales qui ont du sens

Writing the name

One word. Lowercase **a**, capital **S**. It stays lowercase even at the start of a sentence — that's the point of it.

arcaniStudio CORRECT

Arcani Studio NEVER

ArcaniStudio NEVER

ARCANISTUDIO NEVER

arcani studio NEVER

Design principles

1. **Editorial restraint.** Typography and spacing carry the hierarchy — not decoration.
2. **One accent.** Brand orange, used deliberately, once per view.
3. **Break the centre reflex.** Asymmetric and considered beats symmetric and safe.
4. **Plain, specific copy.** Numbers over adjectives. No buzzwords.
5. **Intentional light and dark.** Both surfaces are in use; the transition between them is a decision, not an accident.

Warm, editorial, **crafted**

Confident and premium — not corporate. Typographic and considered — not loud or templated.

Warm

Cream surfaces, a human orange, plain words. We sound like people who answer the phone.

Editorial

Pages read like a well-set article: rhythm, whitespace, hairline rules, real hierarchy.

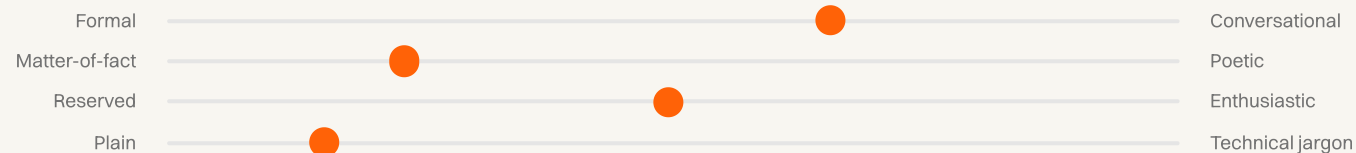
Crafted

The details are the argument. Nothing shipped that we wouldn't put in the portfolio.

Direct

Specific claims with numbers attached. If we can't back it, we don't say it.

WHERE WE SIT



WORDS WE USE

ship · build · own · scope · audit · handoff · milestone · discovery call · measurable · 7–10 business days

WORDS WE DON'T

leverage · synergy · seamless · cutting-edge · game-changing · revolutionary · best-in-class · robust solutions · digital transformation journey · unlock

Say the **specific** thing

Left column is live site copy. Right column is what the same idea sounds like when it goes generic.

✓ **WRITE THIS**

"A landing page ships in 7-10 business days, a full website in 3-5 weeks."

✗ **NOT THIS**

~~"Lightning-fast turnaround times tailored to your needs."~~

✓ **WRITE THIS**

"Book a 30-minute call. No pitch decks, no commitment — just the fastest path from idea to launch."

✗ **NOT THIS**

~~"Let's connect and explore how we can synergize on your digital transformation journey."~~

✓ **WRITE THIS**

"On final payment, the code, designs and data belong to you. No license traps."

✗ **NOT THIS**

~~"We offer industry-leading, client-first ownership terms."~~

✓ **WRITE THIS**

"We dig into your users, competitors and constraints before touching a pixel."

✗ **NOT THIS**

~~"Our proven, holistic discovery framework unlocks your true potential."~~

RULE OF THUMB

If a competitor could paste the sentence onto their own site unchanged, it isn't ours. Rewrite it with a number, a name, or a constraint.

SENTENCE LENGTH

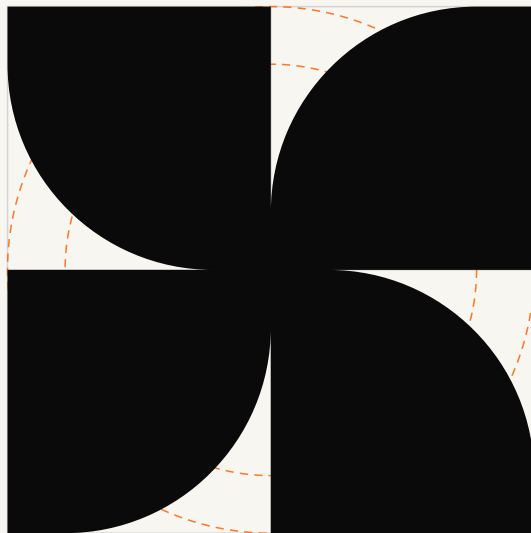
Short first sentence. Then one longer one that carries the detail. Em dashes for the aside, not semicolons.

BILINGUAL

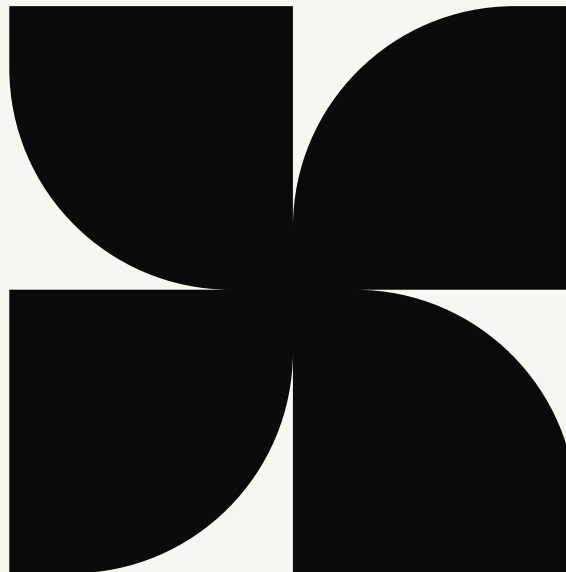
English and French are peers, not translations. French copy is written for French readers — same shape, same key count, never machine-translated.

One path, four quadrants

A pinwheel cut from a 256 × 256 square. Each quadrant is a square with one corner carved by an arc — the carve alternates direction, so the shape turns without ever rotating.



Construction — 256 unit artboard, arc radii **r100** and **r128** struck from centre.



The mark — primary lockup, ink on cream.

SPECIFICATION

ARTBOARD	256 × 256, square, no padding baked in
GEOMETRY	Single closed path — no strokes, no compound shapes, no groups
FILL	currentColor, so the mark inherits text colour anywhere it's placed
ARC RADII	100 (inner carve) and 128 (outer carve)
CORNER OFFSET	28 units — the flat left on each carved corner
FILE	public/logo.svg · component src/components/Logo.astro

Wordmark

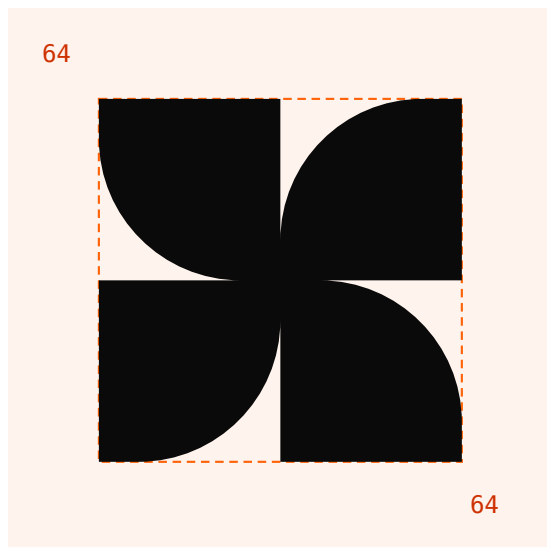
There is no drawn wordmark. When the name is set beside the mark, it is **Switzer Semibold**, optical size matched to the mark's height, with a gap equal to half the mark width.



Give it room

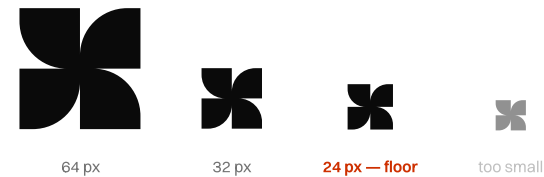
The mark is dense and geometric. It reads badly when something else crowds the carved corners.

CLEAR SPACE = ¼ OF THE MARK WIDTH



At the 256 artboard that's **64 units** on every side. Nothing enters that band — no type, no rule, no photo edge, no other logo. The favicon already bakes this in: its viewBox is `-32 -32 320 320`, a 12.5% inset for small-size legibility.

MINIMUM SIZES



Floors

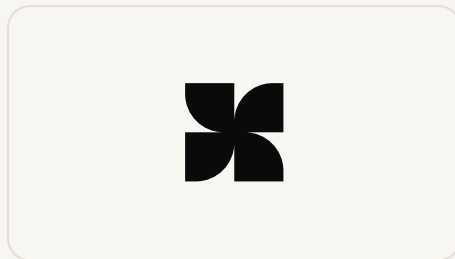
Screen	24 px minimum
Print	8 mm minimum
Favicon	16 px — use <code>favicon.svg</code> , which carries its own padding
Embroidery / etch	12 mm — the carve closes up below this

IN THE HEADER

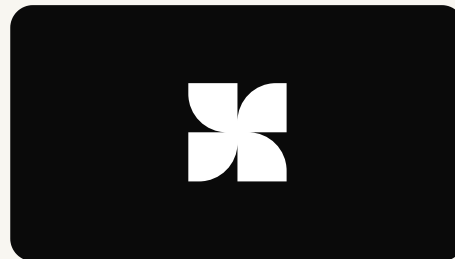
`Logo.asstro` defaults to `h=6 w=6` (24 px). That's the floor, not a default to shrink from — if the nav gets denser, keep the mark and drop something else.

The mark takes the colour of the text

Because it's filled with `currentColor`, there is no separate "white version" file to keep in sync. Set the text colour and the mark follows.



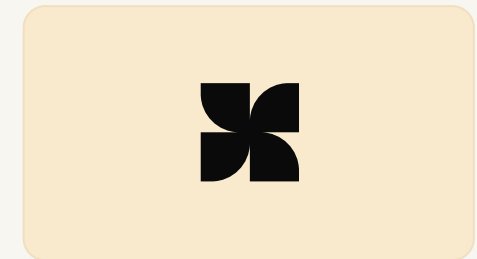
Primary. Ink `#0A0A0A` on cream `#F8F6F1`. 18.3:1.



Reversed. White on ink. 19.8:1. Used on dark sections and the cover.



On accent. Ink on primary-500 — 6.6:1. Never white on orange.



On papaya. Ink on `#FAEACD` — the hero glow tint. 16.7:1.

The grey variant



`#545454`

as shipped in `public/logo.svg`

The standalone SVG ships mid-grey so it sits at the same weight as the grayscale client logos in a logo wall. Use it **only** in peer contexts — partner strips, directory listings, footer credit rows. Anywhere the brand speaks for itself, use ink or white.

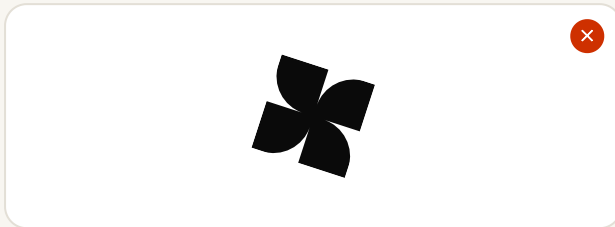
On photography and shaders

The mark has no built-in container, so it needs the background to do the work. Over a shader gradient or an image, place it on an area that is uniformly light or uniformly dark and clears **4.5:1** against the fill you chose.

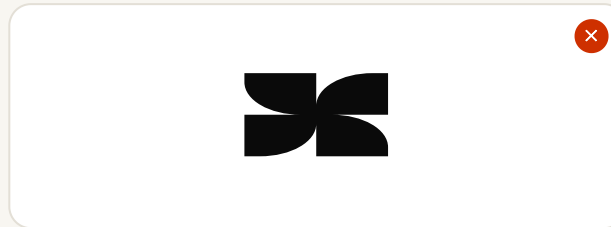
If you can't find that area, don't add a scrim behind the mark alone — move the mark, or place it on a solid band that runs the full width of the composition.

Six ways to break it

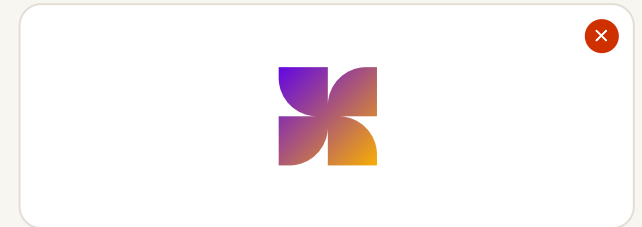
The geometry is the identity. Every one of these makes it read as a different mark.



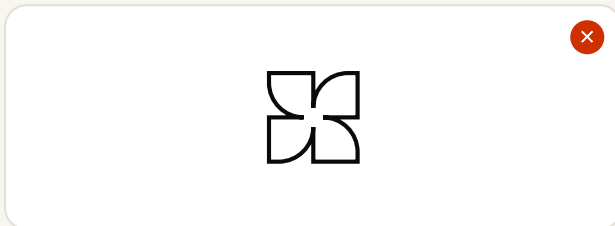
Don't rotate. The pinwheel already implies motion. Turning it just looks like a mistake.



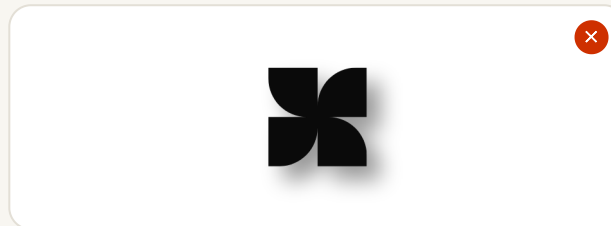
Don't stretch. Scale proportionally, always. The artboard is square and stays square.



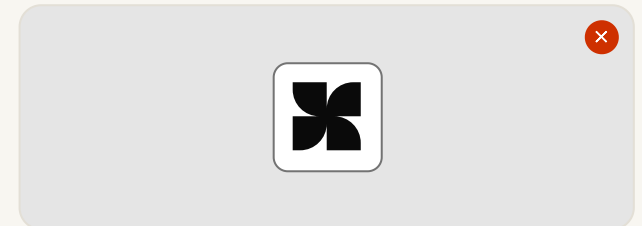
Don't recolour. Ink, white, or the single grey. Gradients are for backgrounds, never for the mark.



Don't outline. It's a filled path. An outlined version loses the solid-to-void relationship entirely.



Don't add effects. No shadow, bevel, glow, or 3D extrude. Flat, always.



Don't box it. No holding shape, badge, or plate. Clear space replaces the container.

Also: don't redraw it by hand, don't trace it from a screenshot, don't use it as a repeating pattern tile at small scale, and don't set it in a sentence as a letterform substitute.

Brand orange

One accent, seven steps. primary-500 is the brand colour; the rest exist so it can survive different backgrounds and text sizes.



WHICH STEP, WHEN

JOB	STEP
Accent word in a headline on cream	primary-700 — 4.8:1
Accent word in a headline on ink	primary-400 — 8.2:1
Solid CTA button	primary-600 fill
Badge / "new" pill	primary-500 fill, white 5.4 pt semibold
Text selection	primary-500 fill, white text
Body copy, anywhere	Never orange. Ink or palette-600.

One live issue worth fixing

White on primary-600 measures **3.57:1**. That clears WCAG AA for large text (≥ 24 px, or ≥ 18.66 px bold) but **not** for normal-size text.

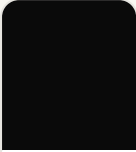
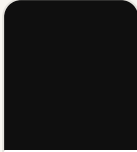
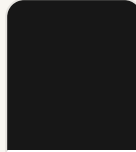
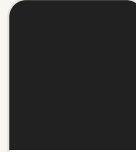
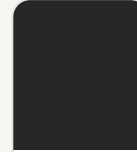
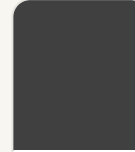
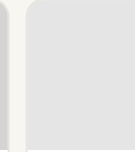
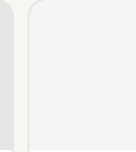
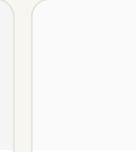
The hero CTA sets its label at 16 px on primary-600 — so it currently fails AA at that size.

Two ways out: raise the label to 24 px, or move the fill to primary-700 (**5.19:1**), which passes at any size and barely shifts the look.

Neutrals do the heavy lifting

Thirteen greys, one warm cream, one near-black. The orange only works because everything around it is disciplined.

NEUTRAL PALETTE

												
0A0A0A 950	0F0F0F 925	171717 900	212121 850	262626 800	404040 700	525252 600	737373 500	A1A1A1 400	D4D4D4 300	E5E5E5 200	F5F5F5 100	FAFAFA 50

SURFACES

#F8F6F1

background-light — the default page. Warm, not white. Ink text at 18.3:1.

#0A0A0A

palette-950 — dark sections. White headings, **palette-400** body at 7.7:1.

#FFFFFF

white — cards and pills lifted off the cream. Never the page background.

GRADIENT ACCENTS — BACKGROUNDS ONLY



ai-accent
#6308E2



chocolate-cosmos
#330014



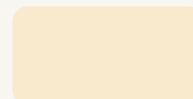
carmine
#A10012



spanish-orange
#DF5B00



selective-yellow
#FAAF01



papaya-whip
#FAEACD

These belong to the shader gradient and the hero glow. They are **not** UI colours — never use them for text, borders, buttons, or icons.

SEMANTIC



#158C41
success

Form success states only. White on it measures 4.32:1 — pair it with dark text, or use it as an icon/border rather than a filled button with white label.

There is no dedicated error colour. Errors use **primary-700** — the brand already reads as a warning red-orange at that step.

Five percent orange

The accent earns attention by being rare. If two things on a screen are orange, one of them is wrong.

70% SURFACE

25% INK & GREY

5%

Rough target for any full page or deck. The dark share rises on dark sections; the orange share does not.



DO

One primary CTA per view, in primary-600. Everything else is a text link or a ghost button.



DON'T

Set body copy, long headings, or nav links in orange. On cream, primary-500 is 2.78:1 — unreadable by AA standards.



DO

Use the serif accent word in primary-700 to carry the emphasis in a headline — one word or one line, not both halves.



DON'T

Introduce a second accent hue for a "secondary" action. Secondary means less weight, not a different colour.



DO

Let cream and ink alternate in long scrolls. Transitions between them are compositional decisions — fade or hard cut, chosen on purpose.



DON'T

Use orange gradient text, orange drop shadows, or orange section backgrounds behind body copy.

ON CREAM

Ink #0A0A0A headings · palette-600 body · palette-200 hairlines · white cards · orange accent.

COLOUR IN USE

ON INK

White headings · palette-400 body · white/15 hairlines · palette-900 cards · primary-400 accent.

SELECTION

Global rule: selected text sits on primary-500 in white. Set once in ::selection; don't override per component.

Measured, not assumed

Target is WCAG AA: 4.5:1 for body text, 3:1 for large text (≥ 24 px, or ≥ 18.66 px bold) and for UI boundaries.

APPROVED PAIRS

FOREGROUND ON BACKGROUND	RATIO	VERDICT
Ink on cream	18.33	AAA
White on ink	19.80	AAA
Ink on papaya-whip	16.70	AAA
palette-300 on ink	13.36	AAA
primary-300 on ink	11.08	AAA
primary-400 on ink	8.15	AAA
palette-400 on ink	7.66	AAA
palette-600 on cream	7.23	AAA
Ink on primary-500	6.60	AA
White on primary-700	5.19	AA
primary-700 on cream	4.80	AA
palette-500 on cream	4.39	AA LARGE

HANDLE WITH CARE

FOREGROUND ON BACKGROUND	RATIO	VERDICT
White on primary-600	3.57	AA LARGE
primary-600 on cream	3.31	AA LARGE
White on primary-500	3.00	AA LARGE
primary-500 on cream	2.78	FAILS
White on success	4.32	AA LARGE

Beyond colour

- **Motion.** Every animation and transition respects prefers-reduced-motion — including the Lenis scroll easing and the shader background.
- **Focus.** Visible focus ring on every interactive element. Never outline: none without a replacement.
- **Meaning.** Colour never carries meaning alone — pair it with a label, an icon, or a shape.
- **Targets.** 44 × 44 px minimum for anything tappable.
- **Language.** lang is set correctly per locale so screen readers pronounce French copy as French.

Three families, **clear jobs**

All three are self-hosted as variable WOFF2 from `public/fonts/` with `font-display: swap`. No external font requests, no CLS on load.

Switzer

PRIMARY — EVERYTHING BY DEFAULT

Variable 100–900, plus static Light through Bold. Set as `--font-sans` and `--font-heading` — body, UI, nav, and headings all use it.

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz 0123456789

Light 300 — button labels
Regular 400 — body copy
Medium 500 — UI labels, emphasis
Semibold 600 — headings, wordmark
Bold 700 — rare, data emphasis

Reckless Neue

ACCENT SERIF — THE EMPHASISED HALF

Set as `--font-reckless`. Its job is the second line of a headline, in `primary-700` on cream. One accent phrase per screen — it stops working the moment it becomes the body face.

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz 0123456789

Digital Potential

Live use — hero line 2, Medium 500, `primary-700`. Also: the tagline, and pull quotes. Never at body size.

Clash Display

DISPLAY ALTERNATE — RESERVE

Set as `--font-clash`, variable 200–700. Held for large display moments where Switzer Semibold feels too neutral — campaign artwork, cover slides. Not for running text or UI.

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz 0123456789

Display 600

If a piece uses Clash, it uses it once, large. Two display faces on one page is one too many.

The scale

Named tokens, not arbitrary sizes. If a size isn't in this table, it needs a reason — and probably a new token.

TOKEN	SIZE	LINE-HEIGHT	WHERE IT'S USED
text-h1	64 px	1.0	Page-defining headline. On the homepage it's fluid: <code>clamp(45px, 3.69vw + 31.9px, 85px)</code> .
text-h2	48 px	1.0	Section headline
text-h3	36 px	1.2	Sub-section, large card title
text-h4	28 px	1.2	Card and panel titles
text-h5	20 px	1.2	Small headings, list titles
text-h6	18 px	1.2	Hero subtitle, lead paragraph
text-subtitle	20 px	1.4	Standfirst under a headline
text-p-regular	16 px	1.4	Body copy — the default
text-p-bold	16 px	1.4	Emphasised body
text-p-integration	16 px	1.0	Single-line labels in tight rows
text-tooltip-l	14 px	1.2	Badges, meta, captions
text-tooltip-m	12 px	1.1	Fine print, legal
text-tooltip-s	8 px	0.9	Uppercase micro-labels inside pills only

SETTING RULES

- **Tighten as you scale up.** Headlines carry negative tracking (about -0.02 em); body copy stays at default.
- **Measure.** 60–75 characters per line for body. The hero column caps at `max-w-3xl` for exactly this reason.
- **One accent per headline.** The serif takes one line or one phrase, never both halves.
- **No all-caps paragraphs.** Uppercase is for micro-labels at 8–14 px with generous tracking, nothing longer.
- **Numbers align.** Tabular figures in tables, pricing, and stats.

Hierarchy in one block

Unleash Your Digital Potential

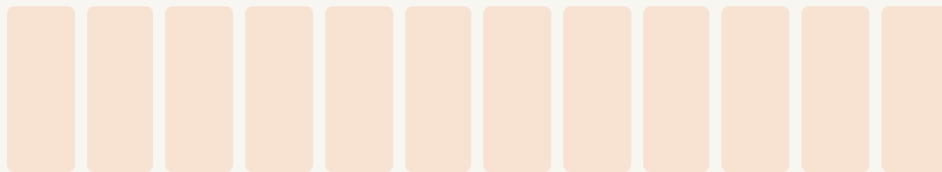
Subtitle at text-h6, palette-600 — sets the claim in plain language.

Body at text-p-regular carries the detail underneath.

Space is the decoration

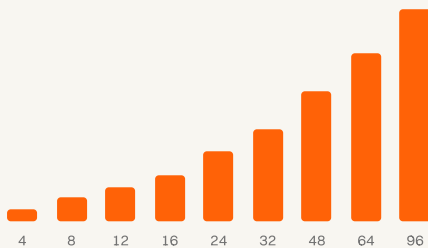
Twelve columns, a 4 px rhythm, hairline rules. Nothing else is needed to build hierarchy.

GRID — 12 COLUMNS



Content columns run **asymmetric by default**: 7/5, 8/4, 5/7. A 6/6 split is the exception, not the starting point. Reading columns cap at `max-w-3xl`; full-bleed is reserved for dark sections and shader backgrounds.

SPACING — 4 PX BASE



Tailwind's default scale, unmodified. Section padding sits at 96–160 px on desktop; the gap between a heading and its body is 16–24 px, never more.

RADIUS — BASE 0.625 REM (10 PX)

TOKEN	COMPUTED	USE
<code>radius-sm</code>	6 px	Inputs, tags
<code>radius-md</code>	8 px	Small cards
<code>radius-lg</code>	10 px	Default card
<code>radius-xl</code>	14 px	Panels
<code>radius-2xl</code>	18 px	Feature blocks
<code>radius-3xl</code>	22 px	Large media frames
<code>radius-4xl</code>	26 px	Hero panels
<code>rounded-full</code>	<code>pill</code>	Every button, badge and pill — no exceptions

Borders and rules

One weight: **1 px**. palette-200 on cream, white/15 on ink. Rules divide, they don't decorate — no side-stripe accent borders, no coloured left rails on cards.

Shadows are effectively unused. Depth comes from a change of surface — white card on cream — not from a blur.

Motion that **answers**

Every movement responds to something the visitor did — a hover, a scroll, a submit. Nothing loops on its own except the ambient shader.

Roll-up label

The signature interaction. On hover, the button label slides up out of frame while a duplicate slides in from below — **500 ms**, both halves in sync. Used on the primary CTA.

Chevron exit / enter

The icon leaves right and re-enters from the left over the same 500 ms. Direction always follows the action's meaning — forward is right.

Scroll easing

Lenis owns scroll easing on the homepage; native scroll-behavior is deliberately set to auto so anchor jumps aren't double-eased.

TIMINGS

INTERACTION	DURATION	CURVE
Hover / colour change	150–200 ms	ease-out
Roll-up label, chevron	500 ms	ease-in-out
Scroll reveal	400–600 ms	ease-out, staggered
Ambient shader	continuous	background only, never behind body copy

Reduced motion is not optional

Every animation, transition, scroll effect and shader must check prefers-reduced-motion: reduce and degrade to a static state — not a faster version of the same movement.

That includes Lenis, the wormhole shader, the counters, and the scroll-reveal text. If a component can't be made static, it doesn't ship.

DO

Move one property at a time. Opacity and transform only — they're the cheap ones.

DO

Stagger a group by 40–80 ms so a list reads as a sequence, not a flash.

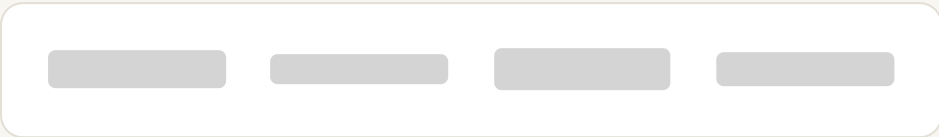
DON'T

Animate on load, bounce, parallax the type, or auto-advance a carousel.

Show the work

We're judged on craft, so the imagery is the craft: real screens, real client marks, generated gradients. Never a stock photo of people pointing at a laptop.

CLIENT LOGOS



Every client mark ships **grayscale WebP**, matched on **optical** height rather than bounding box — a wide wordmark and a square mark are balanced by eye, not by pixels. Colour returns only inside a case study, never in the logo wall.

SCREENS AND CASE STUDIES

Product shots over people shots. Crop to the part of the interface that carries the point, on a cream or ink field with generous margin. No laptop mockups on wooden desks, no floating perspective phones, no drop shadows faking depth.

PHOTOGRAPHY, WHEN IT'S UNAVOIDABLE

Warm, natural light. Real workspace, real people, no eye contact with the lens. If the only option is stock, use a gradient or a screen instead.

GENERATED BACKGROUNDS



The shader gradient draws from the accent set — chocolate-cosmos, carmine, spanish-orange, selective-yellow, with ai-accent reserved for AI-related surfaces. It sits behind headlines and empty space only, at low enough intensity that any text over it still clears 4.5:1.

File standards

Format	WebP first; SVG for any mark or diagram
Portfolio shots	1600 px wide, quality ~80
Client logos	Grayscale WebP, ~400 px wide
OG image	1200 × 630, mark + one line of copy on ink
Alt text	Always. Describe the content, not the file.

The pieces

Everything interactive is a pill. Everything static is a hairline. That's most of the system.

PRIMARY BUTTON

Book a discovery call

primary-600 fill · white Light 300 · fully rounded · white circle icon holder at 32 px · label rolls up on hover over 500 ms. **Set the label at 24 px, or move the fill to primary-700, to clear AA.**

BADGE AND PILL

NEW

 AI automation now available

Outer pill: white fill, palette-200 border, palette-600 label at 14 px. Inner badge: primary-500 fill, white uppercase Semibold at 8 px. Only the inner badge carries colour.

CARD

Web Development

Fast, scalable applications built with React, Next.js, Astro and TypeScript — optimised for speed, SEO and Core Web Vitals.

White on cream, radius-lg, 1 px palette-200 border, 24-32 px padding. No shadow, no accent stripe, no icon tile.

STATES

STATE	TREATMENT
Hover	One step darker on fills; underline appears on text links. 150-200 ms.
Focus	Visible ring, 2 px, offset 2 px, in primary-500. Never removed.
Active	No scale-down bounce. Fill darkens, nothing moves.
Disabled	50% opacity, cursor not-allowed. Keep the shape.
Loading	Label replaced in place; the button keeps its width so nothing reflows.
Error	primary-700 text plus an icon — never colour alone.

FORMS

EMAIL

you@company.com

Label above the field, always visible — placeholders are not labels. radius-sm, 1 px palette-300 border, 44 px minimum height. Validation messages sit below the field, never as a tooltip.

TEXT LINK

Ink with a 1 px underline at 40% opacity, going solid on hover. On dark, primary-400. Links inside body copy never lose their underline — the underline is the affordance, colour alone isn't.

The anti-references

A brand is defined as much by what it refuses. These are the defaults every template falls into — and the reason clients can't tell two agencies apart.

THE GENERIC SAAS TEMPLATE LOOK



Gradient text on headlines.



Hero metric blocks — "10k+ users · 99.9% uptime · 24/7 support" — with no source behind the numbers.



A tiny uppercase eyebrow above every single section heading.



Glassmorphism, neon glow borders, and floating blurred blobs behind everything.

CORPORATE AGENCY CLICHÉS



Stock photography of diverse teams high-fiving around a laptop.



Identical three-card icon grids where the icons carry no information.



01 / 02 / 03 numbering scaffolded onto every section whether it's a sequence or not.



Coloured side-stripe accent borders down the left edge of cards and quotes.

The test before anything ships: **could a competitor swap their logo onto this and have it still work?** If yes, it isn't finished — go back and put something specific in it.



Where the **real** files live

This book explains the system. The repository holds it.
When the two disagree, the repository wins — then update this book.

IN THE REPO

Tokens	<code>src/styles/global.css</code>
Mark (component)	<code>src/components/Logo.astro</code>
Mark (file)	<code>public/logo.svg</code>
Favicon	<code>public/favicon.svg</code>
Fonts	<code>public/fonts/</code>
Copy (EN + FR)	<code>src/i18n/ui.ts</code>
Brand brief	<code>PRODUCT.md</code>

TYPEFACES

Switzer and Clash Display — Indian Type Foundry / Fontshare.

Reckless Neue — Displaay Type Foundry.

Check licence coverage before using them in client deliverables; the web licence does not automatically cover a client's own brand.